According to Fauja Singh's widow Bibi Amarjit Kaur, Bhindranwale had slipped away from the procession early on and had returned to the Golden Temple. Amarjit Kaur never forgave Bhindranwale; she formed a group called Akhand Kirtani Jatha, which continued to be a thorn in Bhindranwale's flesh till the very end. She was one of the very few who had the courage to openly criticize Bhindranwale from inside the Golden Temple complex for his cowardice.

While the Congress in Punjab did everything to give credit to Bhindranwale for his defence of Sikh beliefs, the Akali Dal leadership, due to its coalition compulsions, did not do anything to support the anti-Nirankari agitation. On the other hand, the Sikh leadership in Delhi, especially those linked to the Delhi Sikh Gurudwara Management Committee (DSGMC), openly supported the anti-Nirankari agitation, possibly because of the Congress party's control over its affairs.

The Nirankari movement had started with the teachings of Baba Dyal Singh in the early nineteenth century. Agra-based Baba Dyal Singh emphasized the importance of a living guru, while mainstream Sikhism accepts the Guru Granth Sahib as the final guru of the faith. In 1929, one segment of the Nirankaris led by Baba Buta Singh, now known as the Sant Nirankari Mission which has its headquarters in Delhi, disassociated itself from the original Nirankari movement as well as from mainstream Sikhism and became an independent sect. The Amritsar convention was held by this group. Due to its belief in a living guru as well as its significant differences in other practices, the Nirankari movement is considered heretic to Sikhism by Sikhs in general.

Dal Khalsa

Whenever Bhindranwale was asked by reporters or others about Khalistan, he would say that he would not refuse the offer of Khalistan if made by the government. Because he would not make Khalistan his core demand, which was central to the Op-1 strategy, the 1 Akbar Road group, specially Zail Singh, came up with the novel idea of floating an organization that would openly demand